Parallel Two

Learn the Rules of the Game

Authority is documented. Influence is discovered.

Leadership Model: RULES

Put It into Play

Reflection Questions

Make time to reflect before you lead forward.

1. Do I understand the organization's strategy, priorities, and decision rights?

2. Where does actual practice differ from stated policy?

3. Where do I need stronger relationships to be effective here?

Team Conversation Prompts

Use these questions to spark meaningful conversations with your team.

1. What norms shape how things really get done on our team?

2. What does someone need to understand to be effective here that is not written down?

3. Who shapes decisions or provides trusted advice without formal authority?

4. What do our rewards, priorities, and tolerated behaviors reveal about what we value?

Manager Conversation Prompts

Use these questions during your next one-on-one or performance discussion.

1. What unwritten expectations should I better understand before challenging how work gets done?

2. Who could help me better understand the organization and build relationships across the network?

3. Where could I strengthen my credibility before asking for support?

Take Action

Which one or two of these actions would benefit my team and our performance most?

1. I will clarify the formal decision rights and performance expectations relevant to my role.

2. I will observe how work actually happens and identify unwritten expectations.

3. I will identify key influencers and build relationships across the organization.

4. I will compare what leaders say with what they reward, fund, and prioritize.

5. I will seek a mentor or experienced colleague and ask questions about how to be effective here.

